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AU PAIR & ELDERLY CARE GIVING

A Comprehensive Course

2023-2024



MODULE ONE: CHILD DEVELOPMENT.

KEY LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- **Child development.**
- **Preparing play activities for children.**
- **Safety at play.**
- **Observation and planning for play activities.**
- **Food and nutrition, child health and hygiene.**
- **Child development – language and communication development.**
- **Babies and infants.**
- **Inclusive early childhood environments and inclusive activities.**
- **Stages of play, communicating with children.**
- **Children and families, culture and diversity.**
- **Putting it all together – programming and working in early childhood settings.**
- **Common illness and allergies.**



DEFINITION OF TERMS

1. **Early childhood:** The period from birth through age 8 during which children grow, learn and develop more rapidly than at any other time in their lives.
2. **Early care and education (ECE):** All forms of organized and sustained activities, often center- or school-based, designed to foster learning and emotional and social development in children such as preschools, kindergartens and child-care centers.
3. **Early intervention:** A range of services designed to enhance the development of children with disabilities or those at risk of developmental delay. Early intervention services under public supervision generally must be given by qualified personnel and require the development of an individualized family service plan.
4. **Center-based child care:** Programs that are licensed or otherwise authorized to provide child care services in a nonresidential setting.
5. **Home-visiting programs:** An intervention conducted in the home with the child, parents, guardians and other family members. The intervention includes engagement, assessment of family and child needs, development of family care plans, care coordination and case management. For a center-based program, a home visit occurs when the child's teacher or center staff meet with the family in its home environment.
6. **Informal (family, friend and neighbor) child care:** Child care programs provided by relatives, friends and neighbors in the child's own home or in another home, often in unregulated settings.
7. **Licensed child care:** Child care programs operated in homes or in facilities that fall within the regulatory system of a state or community and comply with those regulations.

Many states have different levels of regulatory requirements and use different terms to refer to these levels (for example, licensing, certification, registration).

8. **Licensed family child care:** Child care programs provided by relatives, friends and neighbors operated in homes or in facilities that fall within the regulatory system of a state or community and comply with those regulations. Many states have different levels of regulatory requirements and use different terms to refer to these levels (for example, licensing, certification, registration).



CHILD CARE

Child care, otherwise known as **day care**, is the care and supervision of a child or multiple children at a time, whose ages range from two (2) weeks of age to 18 years. Although most parents spend a significant amount of time caring for their children, child care typically refers to the care provided by caregivers that are not the child's parents. Child care is a broad topic that covers a wide spectrum of professionals, institutions, contexts, activities, and social and cultural conventions. Early child care is an equally important and often overlooked component of child's developments.

DIRRENT TYPES OF CHIDCARE

- **Traditional daycare center**

Most daycare centers provide child care during standard work hours. Many provide half day or full day care for children and sometimes provide meals, as well as field trips. Daycare centers often charge families monthly as opposed to hourly, and they provide a structured routine with large groups of kids. Daycare centers are businesses typically located in stand-alone buildings but sometimes located in religious institutions, schools, or community centers.

- **In-home daycare**

Licensed in-home daycare centers often provide child care in a home setting with fewer children than in traditional daycare centers. Costs may be less for in-home daycares, as well. Licensed in-home daycare centers are typically required to provide age-appropriate activities, meet safety standards, and provide caretakers with child care training.

- **Nanny**

Nannies provide individual in-home care for families. They often commit to full-time hours and are employees of the family they work with. Typically, nannies charge per hour, with an agreed upon schedule of hours determined in advance. Nannies allow for flexible and individualized care, but sometimes cost more than other child care options.

- **Shared nanny**

A shared nanny is similar to a traditional nanny, but, instead of providing child care services to one family, a shared nanny will provide child care services to two families at one time. To alleviate costs, families can choose to hire one nanny to care for all of their children at the same time. This is often done in one of the families' homes and provides children with social interaction as well as lower costs than a dedicated nanny.

- **Au pair**

Au pairs are foreign caregivers who live with the families for whom they provide child care. Parents provide au pairs with room and board as well as a stipend, and, in return, au pairs provide families with child care. Au pairs allow families to have the flexibility of live-in child care, as well as provide children with consistent caretakers who often become like members of the families they serve.

- **Babysitter**

A babysitter provides hourly care for children. They often are part-time caregivers and provide care on an as needed basis.

- **Relative care**

Relatives or friends sometimes take on the child care responsibilities while parents work. Children can benefit when they receive regular care from known and trusted people, and relatives and friends typically are able to provide flexible care. Payment varies depending on situations and relationships.

- **Preschool**

Children who are 2-5 years old may attend preschool. Preschools are similar to daycare centers and provide age-appropriate learning environments for children. They typically charge monthly, and they allow for kids to spend time with other preschoolers and learn in semi-structured environments. Many preschools offer full-day care on weekdays.